



the eagle's eye

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FOREWORD

Hey Unitians, I'm Adhav, and I'm the latest in the long line of Editors-in-Chief of The Eagle's Eye newsletter! I first came aboard The Eagle's Eye in the year 2020 after being given the opportunity to bring my talents to the magazine. I have only managed to discover my passion for writing through the issues. It has been an enjoyable journey, helping to design the covers, writing articles, editing the articles with others, and getting a hold of volumes we have worked hard on.

The fact that our school has given us this opportunity to showcase our creativity in conjunction with the Leaders of English Program makes it all the more remarkable for us. Hopefully, these issues have inspired you to write with us or garnered information from various informative articles. This issue discusses more severe issues like "The Death Penalty" and "Roe v. Wade" and hopes to continue this journey while making it meaningful to our students.

Without further ado, we hope you enjoy our eighth issue of The Eagle's Eye!

Much Love,

Adhav 

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HOMework

BANE? OR BOON? AND HOW TO HANDLE IT?

By Chew Yu Huan (33) and Tanya Ramesh (34)

We always dread it when our teachers constantly end the lesson with, "Okay class so your homework for today is...." We may even think it is unnecessary and a waste of time. Even though it might not be the most enjoyable task, doing it could be useful as a revision tool for our end-of-year examinations and can indicate whether or not we are poor in a particular chapter or subject. However, given our other commitments, homework can be exhausting.

A Stanford University study showed that homework affects students' physical and mental health because at least 56% of students attribute homework as their primary source of stress. This tells us that many students find homework to be stressful, partly because of how some students rush through it the night before. To prevent such matters from occurring, one solution is to get your homework done as soon as possible. By doing so, you do not have to worry about it piling up, then rushing it at the last minute.

Some students may also find that teachers are giving way too much homework, especially when we have to pass it up the next day.

On top of everything else, after school activities such as Co-Curriculum Activities (CCAs) as well as tuition prevent students from finishing their work on time. Because of all these after school activities, students will tend to come up with reasons such as not having enough time to do as well as being too tired to do any work. In order to prevent such things from happening, students can come forward and voice their opinions to the teachers to let them know that they are unable to balance their time management and work, requiring more time.

However, homework can help us in some ways. One is that we can use it to gauge whether we genuinely understood the lesson the teacher has gone through in class. It also helps the teacher understand which part of the lesson you have not understood and can be improved, thus helping us understand the concepts and topics better. Another way homework can help us is that it can boost our knowledge on that particular chapter. By doing so, students can then improve and score better. Therefore, there are times when homework can be valuable and helpful to us.

In conclusion, although homework is tiring and time consuming, we should also consider the benefits that it can give us.



THE DEATH PENALTY

By Cherise Cheong (34)

The death penalty is one of the many legal punishments by law, executions are carried out by long drop hanging (aka hanging via a rope). There are about 33 offences that can warrant the death of the offender including terrorism, kidnapping, use of firearms and course murder.

However, all of these examples stated above are not what this article will be discussing. If you follow the news, you would know Singapore also warrants such punishment to drug traffickers/drug mules.



In 2022 alone, ten people have been hanged in less than five months, all of whom were on death row for drug-related crimes. This shocked many as the speed of execution rates increased drastically ever since the 2-year 'hiatus' due to covid. As expected, such news would be a topic of discourse to the public, with many criticising the strict law, and fighting for what they believe is 'basic human rights'. On the contrary, many support stricter rules as they believe it would reduce drug-related crimes in Singapore and scare potential offenders. People have historically considered the death sentence as a means of defending communities against the very real threats posed by drug trafficking.

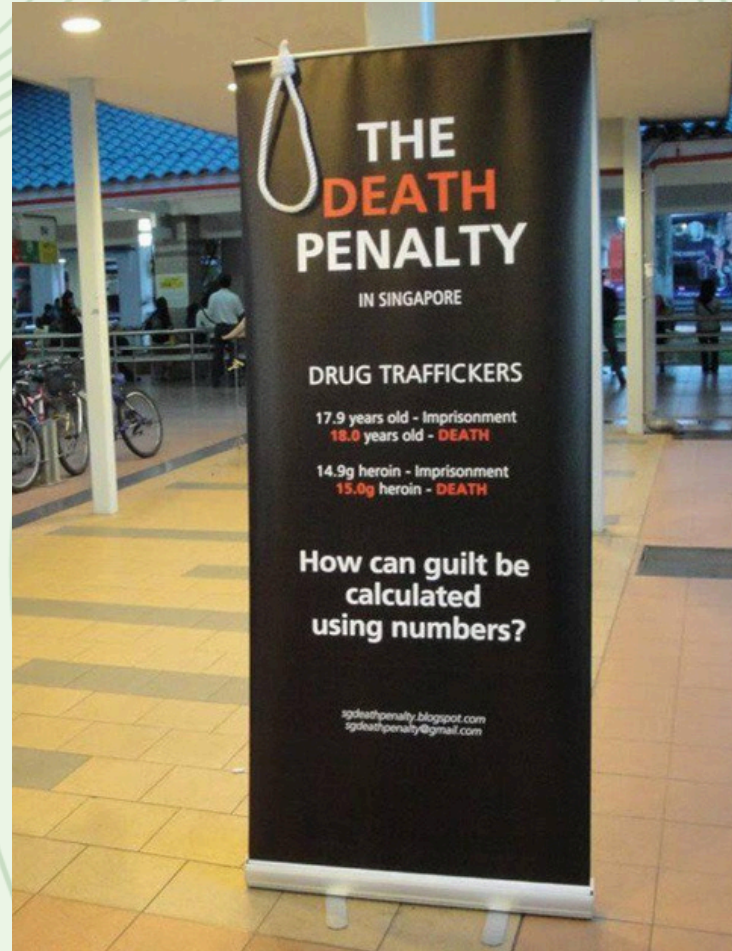
Regardless of viewpoints, the need for compassion toward those who have been convicted along with their families grows among Singaporeans. The relatives of prisoners who are fighting some of the strictest anti-drug laws in the world are being supported by many activists who are working against the clock to bring an end to such executions. However it is to be said protesting in Singapore is not very welcomed either, and is also very much an offence.



Some people want the mandatory death sentence to end(perhaps lighter sentencing depending on the offence), while others want Singapore to completely abolish it. The U.N. Human Rights Office notes that Singapore's strict drug policies unfairly target underprivileged communities and do little to stop the flow of drugs into and out of the city-state. Punishing a single dealer/drug mule (people hired to transport drugs) does not change the fact that it barely fixes the problem; mules can be easily replaced and the people behind such twisted schemes simply earn and laugh in profit. Experts around the world agree there is no evidence proving death sentences are better at deterring crime than other punishments, such as life in prison. But so far, the Singapore government is standing firmly behind its use of the death penalty as a deterrent, ramping up the pace of executions even as other countries in the region relax their drug laws.

THE DEATH PENALTY

The case of Nagaenthran K. Dharmalingam brought attention back to Singapore's death penalty. Before his execution on April 27, the Malaysian drug courier, who had an IQ of 69, had spent more than ten years on death row. At Hong Lim Park, the only location in the nation where Singaporeans can demonstrate without a police permit, hundreds gathered twice in April in a rare display of public solidarity. A petition seeking Mr Nagaenthran's release had received more than 100,000 signatures and many individuals on social media protesting the death penalty and Singapore's drug campaign. However, on the contrary, there were a few who supported the ruling, calling for his death. Many believed that crimes should be harsh as offenders should face the consequences of their crimes and that making them harsh would scare others from committing the same sins. Realistically speaking, the death penalty is also more affordable than having to keep yet another prisoner alive for many years under captivity. Despite all the efforts made by protest, he was scheduled to be hanged on 10 November 2021.



Such topics remain very touchy and controversial. What are your views on this? Do you think such laws are ethical?

Personally, I lean towards the abolishment of compulsory death sentences, light offenders/special offenders should have slightly more leeway with somewhat lighter punishments for smaller offences. Those who commit bigger offences deserve harsher punishments. Such extremes should be purely situational and decided fairly.



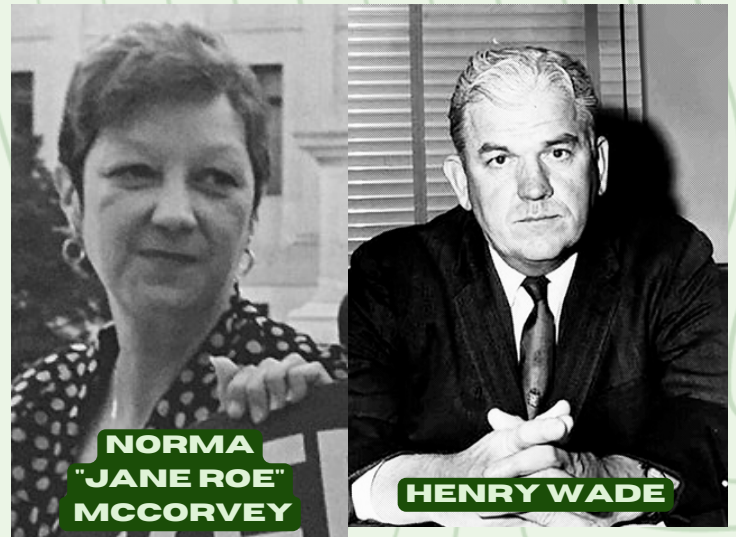
The Topic of *Roe v. Wade*

By Adhav Anbalagan (33), Clea Wong (22) and Nadia Akbar (1B)

On the 24th of June 2022, the United States Supreme Court overturned the historic *Roe v. Wade* landmark decision, which recognized a woman's constitutional right to an abortion and made it lawful in every state in the US. The overturn sparked outrage amongst many US citizens. At the same time, reports suggest that some citizens, primarily Republicans and conservatives, celebrated it as if they were against the course of action.

So, how did *Roe v. Wade* come about in the first place? In 1969, American activist Norma McCorvey, who went by the pseudonym, Jane Roe, attempted to get an abortion in Texas. However, she was not given a chance to do so. This was owing to the fact that there were no abortion clinics at all in Texas. Abortion was illegal in Texas (except when to save someone's life). Her two attorneys filed a lawsuit pertaining to the matter against US District Attorney Henry Wade, who argued that the abortion laws were in accordance with the US Constitution.

A judicial panel was held with three judges to hear the case. Eventually, the judges ruled in favour of Roe, but the case became one of the most controversial cases in the US. After five decades, on the 24th of June this year, The Republican-backed Mississippi legislation that the US Supreme Court upheld outlaws abortions beyond 15 weeks. Astonishingly, within the same day, *Roe v. Wade* was overruled by a 5-4 decision on the same day.



**NORMA
"JANE ROE"
MCCORVEY**

HENRY WADE



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Many US states still allow abortion and the exercise of one's freedom to choose. Currently, the right to an abortion exists in more than a dozen US states. However, since abortion is no longer a protected right, each state will decide who is allowed to have an abortion unless Congress takes action.

On the 24th of June, the US Supreme Court voted with a conservative majority of 6 to 3 to uphold the law. *Roe v. Wade* lost a vote of 5-4 on the same day. *Roe v. Wade* had a judge's rule that allowed abortion before the fetus was alive outside the womb (reportedly). Chung Ja Yang, associate professor of political science at the National University of Singapore (NUS), told CNA. The verdict was "promising".

Abortion and the right of choice are still legal in some US states, especially liberal ones. More than ten states now have laws protecting abortion rights but by removing abortion as a constitutional right, abortion rights will now be determined by individual states unless Congress intervenes, which, according to CNN, is currently banned.



Why Does a Majority of the Public Disagree with the Overturn?

According to research done by Pew Research Centre, more than half of US Citizens segmented by specific demographics showed strong disapproval towards the decision to overturn *Roe v. Wade*. Why is this so? This could result from the public's belief that the landmark decision is vital in protecting a woman's decision to terminate her pregnancy. The overruling is still in place as of the writing of this article. Do you approve of the conclusion of the judges to overturn *Roe v. Wade*? Perhaps, the judges could reverse the overturning in the near future. Only time will tell.

Nadia's Take

The *Roe v. Wade* constituency comes with its pros and cons. Some of its pros include trying to discourage women from carelessly getting pregnant. However, this might not be the case for all women, such as victims of assault, rape and/or mentally unsound individuals. These women should not be blamed for getting pregnant and in fact, should receive the necessary help and support for the trauma that they were forced through. By making abortion illegal, these women would be forced to birth and raise a child that's not their own. Following this, the women would go through many emotional struggles which could affect the innocent child. Due to the lack of authorised abortion clinics, some might go to the extremes of getting illegal abortions which can be unsafe for the women and in turn could lead to many health complications and even death. Therefore for the sake of women's health, the *Roe v. Wade* constituency should be removed. Different approaches can be made to avoid unwanted pregnancies such as public education and making laws.

CAN I AFFORD A HOME?!

By Diane Koo (11)

The price of housing in Singapore is influenced by the state of the economy and the population growth, and due to the large population for the small land surface area in Singapore, the housing prices are slowly increasing. The prices of private homes have risen 18.6% since 2020 at the onset of Covid. A partial reason for the increasing prices is due to more foreigners buying properties in Singapore, because regardless of their residential status in Singapore, they will still enjoy less strict restrictions surrounding the purchase of private housing. Another reason is that there is a disruption in the supply chain which started to emerge in late 2020, and it is causing delays in new projects, and hence more people are turning to pre-owned properties.



The ever-increasing prices of housing raise the question of whether the future generation of Singapore will be able to afford a house when we grow up, as the average price of a 4 room resale HDB is about \$420,000 to \$550,000 and the average person's salary is about \$69,396 per year. So even with loans, it will take the average family a while to be able to afford their own home, not to mention factors like having to get a BTO with the ballot system (Build-To-Order. Flat issuing system that offers flexibility in timing and location for owners buying new public houses in the country.) The problem with getting a BTO with the ballot system is that there are many houses but most people want the house in better locations, that's when there are more people putting their names in the ballot box than there are houses in that area. And the problem is that, for example, if 5000 people put their name in the ballot box, 4000 people could leave without a house. And that's when the ballot system becomes a problem. In the 1980s, the average price of a 4 room flat was about \$80,000, and the average person's salary was about \$12,513 per year. Comparing those prices to modern day prices, It seems to me that in about 10 years, people will probably need to be prepared to pay about \$600,000 for an average house.



CAN I AFFORD A HOME?!

When I was younger, I aimed to live in a condominium, now I feel concerned about whether I would be able to afford a regular HDB. Right now, the average person would take a very long time to purchase a house, if in the future the average person's salary doesn't increase enough, it would take even longer to be able to afford a house. Thoughts like these make me wonder if I will ever be able to afford a house in the future.



Enhanced CPF Housing Grants



My worries eventually got the better of me and I decided to do some research. By doing so, I found out that there are some benefits that are put in place to help us better afford a home. For example, if you buy a house for the first time, and you're buying as a family/couple, you can get up to \$80 000 in grants, while singles can enjoy up to \$40 000. Or, if you're buying a house to live with or near your parents/children, you can apply for the Proximity Housing Grant (PHG) You can receive up to \$30 000 to live with your parents/children, or \$20 000 to live near your parents/children (within 4km). Another housing grant CPF is given to the lower and middle-income families, and they can receive up to \$80 000, while singles can receive up to \$40 000.

In total, the maximum amount of housing grants you can receive is \$160 000, comprising of \$80 000 for EHG (Enhanced CPF Housing Grant), \$30 000 for PHG (Proximity Housing Grant), and \$50 000 for CPF (Central Provident Fund)

After doing my research I still feel a little wary, but I do feel a little more reassured that I will still be able to afford a house if I work hard. Though there are many concerns with the rising cost of housing, there are many benefits put in place to help us afford houses a little easier than if we needed to get one all by ourselves. I believe that with the benefits put in place, we will all still be able to afford a house that we want in the future if we set our sights on it and work hard.



TRIBES

By Baaliha Rishvana Sulthan Syed (13)

Tribes! Now that's a very interesting topic that can be discussed about. There are so many different tribes in the world and mostly they often have their own practices of their own, just like how we do have certain practices in different religions! Surprisingly, there are more than a 100 uncontacted tribes living in the world today, that too with the exact number still being unknown. Now, let's talk about the different tribes around the world!

Since there are no tribes in Singapore, we will head over to Malaysia to meet some of their tribes! There are only about 4 remaining tribes in Malaysia, they are the: Dusun, Murut, Paintan and the Bajau group.



Dusun

Firstly, let's talk about the Dusun tribe. Now, they live in the State of Sabah Of North Borneo. They form the largest ethnic group in Sabah, and it has also been suggested that the term 'Dusun' was a term used by the Sultan of Brunei to refer to the ethnic groups of inland farmers in present-day Sabah. Additionally, the vast majority of them live in the hills and upland valleys. The Dusuns have also changed and converted to mainstream religions such as Christianity and Sunni Islam. The vast majority of Dusuns live in the hills and have a good reputation! Moreover in their old traditional old setting they use various methods of fishing, including using the juice, Tuba to momentarily stun fish. Harvest Festival is celebrated by them from 1 to 31 May. A few of their most well-known food are meat of a wild boar and rice wine chicken soup. Also their traditional clothes are made out of black velvet fabric with various decorations such as flowers, coloured buttons and so on and so forth.

Did You Know?

The Dunsun of Old traded with the coastal people by bringing their agricultural and forest produce. Others, in the inner part of the country, practiced irrigated rice farming.

Murut

Next, let's move onto the Murut tribe. Unlike the Dusun tribe, they are the least numerous of the indigenous ethnic groups. They inhabit the interior and southeastern parts of Sabah and the territory surrounding the Kalimantan and Sarawak borders. They speak a distinctive Austronesian language also called 'Murut'. Now, what does 'Murut' even mean? It literally means 'Hill People' as they mainly live in the hills. The Murut were the last of Sabah's ethnic groups to renounce headhunting (this means to collect the heads of their enemies as trophies). As with the Iban of Sarawak, collecting these heads of enemies traditionally served a very important role in Murut spiritual beliefs. Next, you may want to know, 'What did the Murut people wear?' . The traditional dress for men was a jacket made of tree bark (*Artocarpus tamaran*), a red loincloth, and a headdress decorated with Argus pheasant feathers. Women wore a black sleeveless blouse and sarong, which fell just below the knees. Like most of the other indigenous groups in Sabah, the Murut decorated their clothing with distinctive beadwork and also made belts out of old silver coins. Another belt made of reddish-brown glass beads plus yellow and blue beads was hung loosely around the waist. Interesting, right?

Did You Know?

Those of Murut origin speak 15 languages and 21 dialects. That's a lot, isn't it?

We have talked our fair share of the tribes in Malaysia so now, let's travel to ...Vietnam!

The main tribes in Vietnam are Jarai, Rade, Bahnar, Koho, Mhong and Stieng.

The Bahnar Tribe

The Bahnar tribe is an ethnic group of Vietnam, mainly living in the central highlands. It has a lot of different branch groups like the Jo'lo'ng, Ro'ngao, KonKde, To'lo, Kriem and Bo^nam. They all communicate using the Bahnar Language that belongs to Mon-Khmer language family. Now You might be wondering, What exactly is Bahnar? Well, Bahnar means mountain which is quite close to their living environment. Now Let's find out more about their culture. The Bahnar people are skilled in playing traditional instruments like ensembles of pitched gongs and string instruments made from bamboo. These instruments are sometimes played in concert for special occasions, which may also involve ceremonial *Rượu cần* (rice wine) drinking and group dancing. The Bahnar tribe also celebrate Koh Kpo (or Groong Kpo Tondi): a festival to express gratitude toward Yang (the god) with the main activity being the stabbing of a water buffalo. Lastly, I will mention some of the members of the tribe who deserve recognition. First we have Dinh Nup. He led the villagers to carry out a war of resistance against the French colonial regime and we have Siu Black who is a popular Singer. What a fascinating tribe!

Book Recommendations

By Manha Norah Sheffy (13)

THE SUMMER I TURNED PRETTY (TRILOGY)

Author: Jenny Han



RECOMMEND TO:
14 years and above.

GENRE:
Romance, fiction

SHORT SUMMARY:

The Summer I Turned Pretty tells the story of fifteen year- old Isabelle (Belly) and the summers she spent at her mother's best friend Susannah's beach house. She goes there every summer and hangs out with Susannah's boys who are older than her. Hoping to fall in love until that one summer which changed everything. That summer she turned pretty.

14 DAYS TO DIE

Author: Vincent Ralph



RECOMMEND TO:
15 years and above

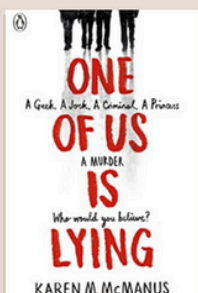
GENRE:
Fiction, Mystery, Thriller

SHORT SUMMARY

Jess. The daughter of the first victim of the serial killer, "Magpie Man". Since then the guy has killed 13 innocent people. Jess has to find him. One way or another. Put a face to the name which killed her mom. That's when she has an amazing idea. She signs up for a Youtube series where cameras follow her as she tries to share with viewers about the murder. But by doing so, she has just put everyone in danger as the serial killer comes out again. for her.

ONE OF US IS LYING.

Author: Karen M. McManus



RECOMMEND TO:
age 13 and above

GENRE:
Mystery, fiction

SHORT SUMMARY:

Five students walk into detention. Only four make it out alive. This story is about 5 students, Bronwyn, Nate, Cooper, Addy and Simon. They all walk into detention one day. Everything was going fine until Simon collapsed. Police declared it as a murder. All four of them claim they didn't do it. However, one of them is lying. Its time to find out why.

LOVE AND GELATO

Author name: Jenna Evans Welch



RECOMMEND TO:
13 years and above

GENRE:
Small town romance, fiction

SHORT SUMMARY

Lina goes to Italy to fulfill that one task her mom gave her when she died. Go to Italy and meet her father. What kind of father doesn't appear for 16 years? Life there becomes boring until she meets a guy, Lorenzo and finds her mom's old diary. The content in the diary shocks her. Maybe this summer isn't so boring after all. People come to Italy for love and gelato but sometimes, they discover much more...